

Two green pledges: can anyone check them?

Labour's ten-minute green space and the PN's net-zero Gozo, tested on open data

THE CLAIM

“Every person ... no more than ten minutes’ walk from an open or green space.”

Partit Laburista, manifesto 2026, priority 19 (our translation)

And the PN programme: a plan for Gozo to be a Net-Zero Island by 2040, afforestation among the measures.

Both parties checked to the same standard. Labour now governs; the PN pledge is an opposition proposal.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*No definition,
no baseline.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

99.9%

Any green or open space

Share of residents already within 800 m (straight line). Read broadly, the pledge is already almost met.

55%

Parks of at least 0.5 ha

Within a realistic ten-minute walk. About 240,000 people are outside. Which one counts? Not said.

No inventory

Gozo emissions

No official figure or boundary. We estimate about 157,000 t CO₂e a year.

6.5×

Gozo's area as forest

Needed to offset Gozo's emissions by afforestation alone at a measured rate. Even optimistically: 2.3×

2040

A plan to make a plan

The PN text relies on cuts first (solar, EVs, buildings); news summaries said “through afforestation”.

FAIR TO SAY

Green space near home is linked to better health, and island decarbonisation is EU policy. The goals are sound; the question is whether they can be measured.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Government: what counts as “open or green space”?

☐ Government: today's baseline and a target year.

☐ PN: a Gozo emissions inventory and its boundary.

☐ PN: how much from cuts, forests and offsets.